# Reiko Laski


Contact Information

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## Education

**Stanford University**, Ph.D. in Economics — 2021 – Expected 2027
Fields: Macroeconomics, Economic Growth, Innovation, Firm Dynamics

**Emory University**, Bachelor of Arts in Economics and Mathematics — 2015 – 2019
Minor in Computer Informatics
Thesis: "Access to Pharmaceuticals in Developing Countries" (advisor: Stephen O'Connell)

## Working Papers

**Sectoral Innovation Complementarities**
*Job Market Paper*

Technological advances in one industry can strengthen incentives for firms in other industries to innovate. I study whether downstream innovation increases demand for upstream inputs and makes developing better inputs more profitable. Using Compustat supply-chain links and financial market reactions to patent grants, I measure changes in suppliers' market value associated with customer innovation. Each additional 1% of a customer's market value created by its own innovation is associated with an additional 0.33% increase in its supplier's market value. These supplier valuation gains predict subsequent increases in sales and patenting, consistent with customer advances expanding demand for inputs and encouraging further innovation by suppliers. I develop and calibrate a multisector endogenous growth model to study how interactions between customer and supplier innovation shape the gap between private and social returns to research. The empirical relationship between customer and supplier valuation gains helps distinguish models with different implications for the allocation of R&D support. In the calibrated model, targeting R&D subsidies toward suppliers raises annual growth by an additional 8 basis points relative to a uniform subsidy at the same fiscal cost.

**Idea Rents and Firm Growth** with Timo Boppart, Pete Klenow, and Huiyu Li
*NBER Working Paper No. 35594*

Which firms drive aggregate productivity growth? We document that firms with high price-earnings ratios tend to see increases in their subsequent earnings relative to sales, which we interpret as rents from ideas (innovation). We construct an endogenous growth model with shocks to firm innovation step sizes and R&D efficiency and calibrate it to match patterns in the data. The model implies that growth would be much lower, even with the same innovative effort, if firms had the same step sizes. The model can be used to infer expected growth contributions of individual firms (such as members of the Magnificent Seven). We find that the share of growth coming from smaller listed firms substantially exceeds their sales share.

## Selected Works in Progress

**The Market's Expectation of AI-Driven Growth**
with Timo Boppart, Pete Klenow, and Huiyu Li

**The Growth Implications of Heterogeneous Firm-to-Firm Knowledge Spillovers**
with Emmanuella Kyei Manu

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| **Policy Writing** | "Why Don't Low-Income Countries Adopt More Productive Technologies?" with Nicholas Trachter. *Richmond Fed Economic Brief* No. 21-11 | 2021 |
| | "The Effect of Lockdown Measures on Unemployment" with Marios Karabarbounis, James Lee, and Nicholas Trachter. *Richmond Fed Special Report* | 2020 |
| **Honors and Awards** | E.S. Shaw and B.F. Haley Fellowship for Economics, SIEPR | 2027 |
| | Centennial Teaching Assistant Award, Stanford School of Humanities and Sciences | 2025 |
| | Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, Stanford University ×3 | 2023, 2024, 2025 |
| | Highest Honors in Economics, Emory University | 2019 |
| | Open Source Macroeconomics Laboratory Student Research Grant, University of Chicago | 2018 |
| **Presentations** | Innovation Complementarities, *Stanford Macroeconomics Seminar* | 2026 |
| | Innovation Complementarities, *Stanford Macro Workshop* | 2026 |
| | Idea Rents and Firm Growth, *Stanford Macro Day* | 2024 |
| **Work Experience** | Research Assistant to Pete Klenow | 2022 – present |
| | Research Associate, Federal Reserve Bank of Richmond | 2019 – 2021 |
| **Teaching Assistantships** | Climate Change and Global Inequality, Stanford | 2026 |
| | International Finance, Stanford | 2025 |
| | International Trade, Stanford | 2023 – 2024 |
| | Intermediate Microeconomics, Emory | 2019 |
| | Introductory Physics, Emory | 2016 – 2018 |
| **Skills** | Python, Stata, MATLAB, Java, SQL, LaTeX, Julia, R | |
| **Professional Activities and Service** | Moderator, Stanford Economics Graduate Career Day Tech Panel | 2026 |
| | Co-Chair, Stanford Women in Macro | 2025 – 2026 |
| | Recruitment Committee, Department of Economics, Stanford University | 2023 |
| | Special Sworn Status Researcher, U.S. Census Bureau | 2022 – present |
| | Growth Reading Group, Stanford University | 2022 – present |
| | Social Chair, Stanford Department of Economics | 2021 – 2022 |
| | Refereeing: *Journal of Political Economy: Macroeconomics* | |